

Overview
Redesigning the Mochi Donuts website from what it is now, to a website with a much nicer visual aesthetic, and a more usable website.

Project Goals

- Improve usability.
- Improve the visual aesthetic.
- Better navigation flow
- Effortless and easier to understand.

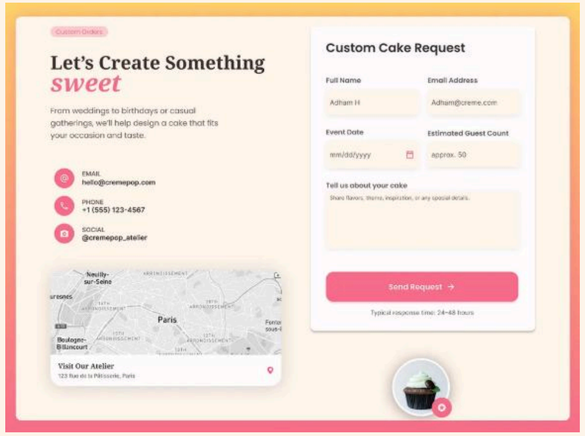
Target Audience
Teenagers to young adults (15-30), families, and sugar lovers around Melbourne.

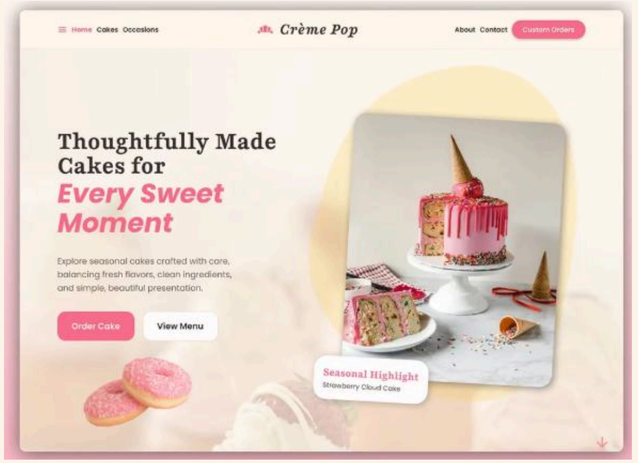
This demographic heavily uses social media, and they discover food brands through apps like TikTok and Instagram before visiting in person. Aesthetics and visual brand identity matter as much as the product itself. Having an aesthetic and fun looking website would attract a lot of the audience, which would lead to them sharing their experiences online, bringing in more customers.

Project Overview

Key Issues	
Navigation Issues	The main product list can only be accessed by clicking the very small “View Menu” button or the pickup/delivery buttons. This adds friction and breaks visibility early on.
Visual Hierarchy	Layout feels very top heavy, and there’s a lot of awkward white space, making it harder to understand where to focus.
Inconsistent Imagery	The donut images constantly vary in size, angle, and background, making the interface of the website feel very messy and incsonsitent, reducing recognition over recall and ruining the visual aesthetic of a website which heavily relies on images.
Design Consistency	Buttons, modals, and layouts feel very templated and don’t align with the overall branding, the website also lacks in any unique branding or personality.
Unnecessary Elements	There are many low-opacity logo overlays on top of the imagery, and extra UI elements that add clutter without improving the usability at all.

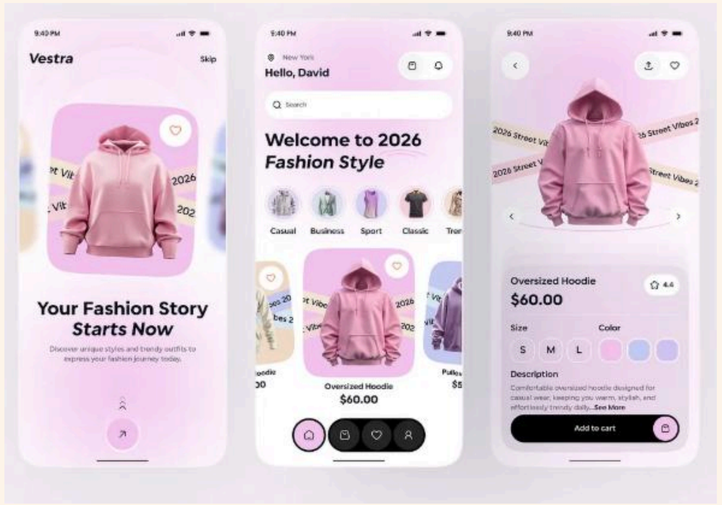
Problem Summary





The screen is clean, but still manages to feel minimal with a bit of content. The strong and vibrant pink colour, feels very delibrate but makes the buttons and typography pop against the pastel palette.

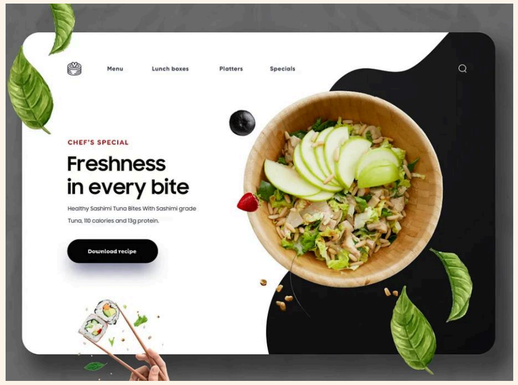
I like the bottom navigation bar is clean and immediately understandable. The product page layout (image top, details bottom, Add to Cart pinned at the bottom)

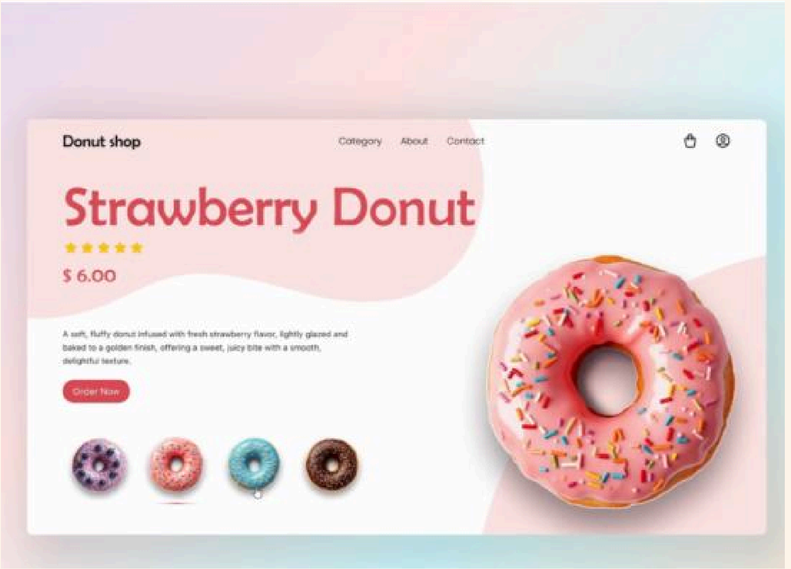




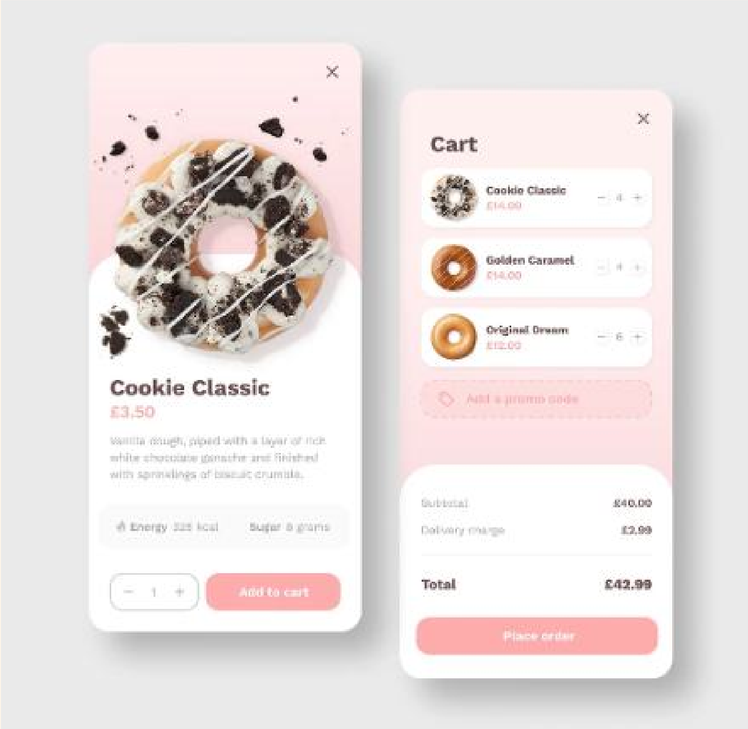
The warm cream background used consistently across all screens creates a strong sense of visual cohesion. The category filter tabs (All / Hot Coffee / Cold Coffee) are a clean solution to the navigation friction problem I identified in Assignment 1.

Inspiration Board





The large hero donut image immediately communicates the product with no confusion. The soft pink blob shape behind the donut adds visual interest without cluttering the layout. The thumbnail row at the bottom is an elegant way to browse flavours.



This is the closest reference to my exact use case. The product modal and cart screen are both clean and minimal. The pink accent colour ties everything together without being overwhelming. The cart shows product thumbnails with quantity controls

Inspiration Board















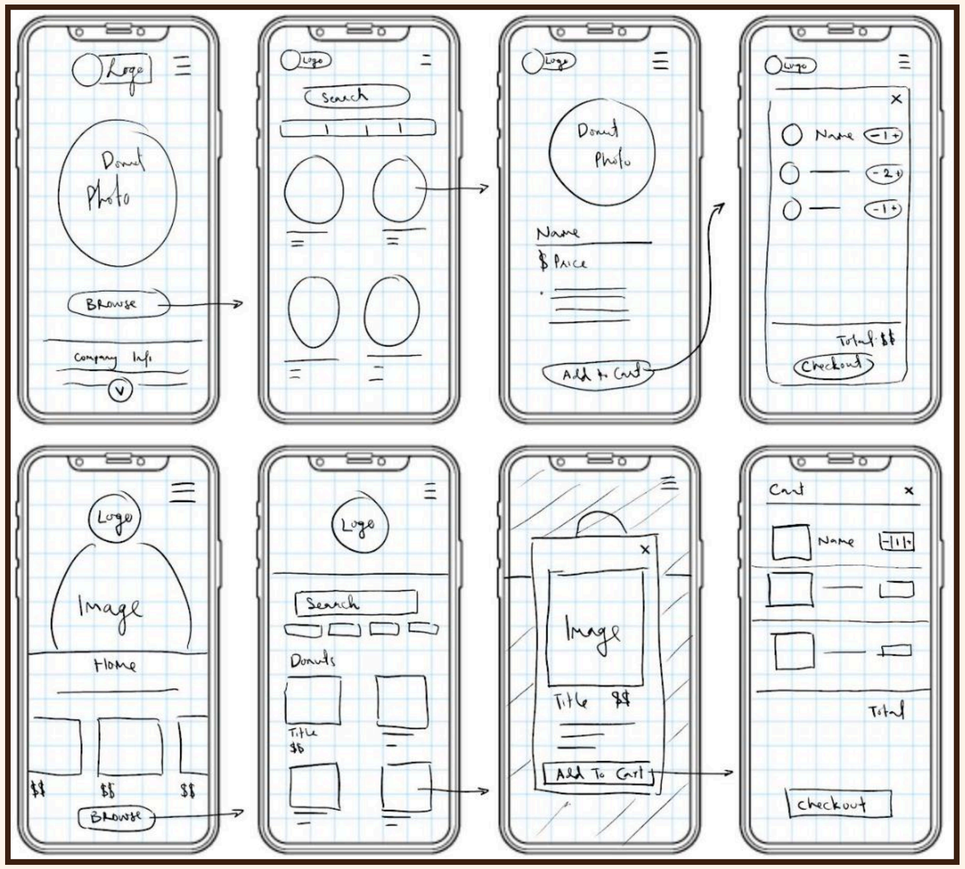
Mood Board

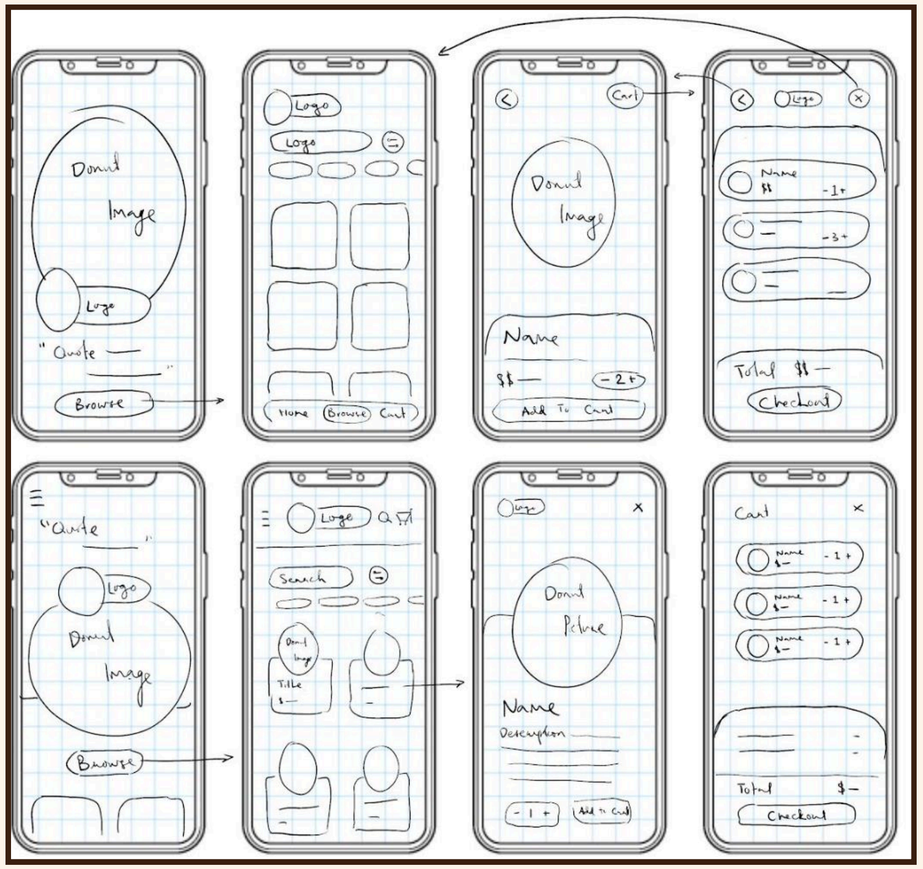
Inspiration & Research	Before sketching anything, I browsed and collected a lot of different visual references from Dribbble, and Behance, as well as just looking through different e-commerce websites with similar food based content. A lot of my focus was on warm palettes, large typography, and a confident hero-page layout. Through my references, I was pointed clearly towards large product imagery, and minimal content, rather than focusing a lot on extra content.
Sketching	I made four rough sketches, exploring different homepage approaches, different navigation ideas, and how the products should be laid out. However, even throughout most of the sketches, I knew I wanted to focus on large product imagery, and have the imagery add to the visual aesthetic of the website, as the original Mochi Donuts lacked with it's imagery, despite having a lot of possiblities.
Low-Fidelity Wireframe	For my low fidelity wireframe, I did like my fourth sketch the most, however, I decided to implement a few different ideas / features from other sketches. Rather than blindly following one of the sketches, I combined the features I liked the most from different sketches.

Process Description

Art Direction Exploration	With the wireframe locked, I styled three different directions for the mobile home page. I was already quite confident with the visual layout and typography, but the main thing I was considering was the colour palette, so I decided to mainly compare the colour choices: Midnight Palette (Dark & Editorial), Original Mochi Palette but improved (Warm peach), and a more Kawaii / Sprinkle Pop style (bright and cute).
High-Fidelity Mockup	I ended up choosing the original Mochi Donuts themed direction, which I then started implementing into the low-fidelity wireframe. Keeping a similar colour scheme allows the redesign to stay similar to it's original branding, rather than completely changing and feeling like a whole new company. I also thought the locked floating navigation bar was a nice touch to stray away from the generic e-commerce website navigation flow, while also staying recognisable. I also tried focusing on the large product imagery, where I AI generated consistent images using the same prompt, and used them confidently throughout the design. Looking very appealing to the audience, and giving it more of a brand personality, and allowing nicer social media presence.
User Feedback	I constantly asked for feedback from roommates and friends on design choices I made throughout the design process. Oncethe high-fidelity mockup was completed, I ran an informal walkthrough with the original participant to check and compare the flow from the original Mochi Donuts website before finalising the report.

Process Description



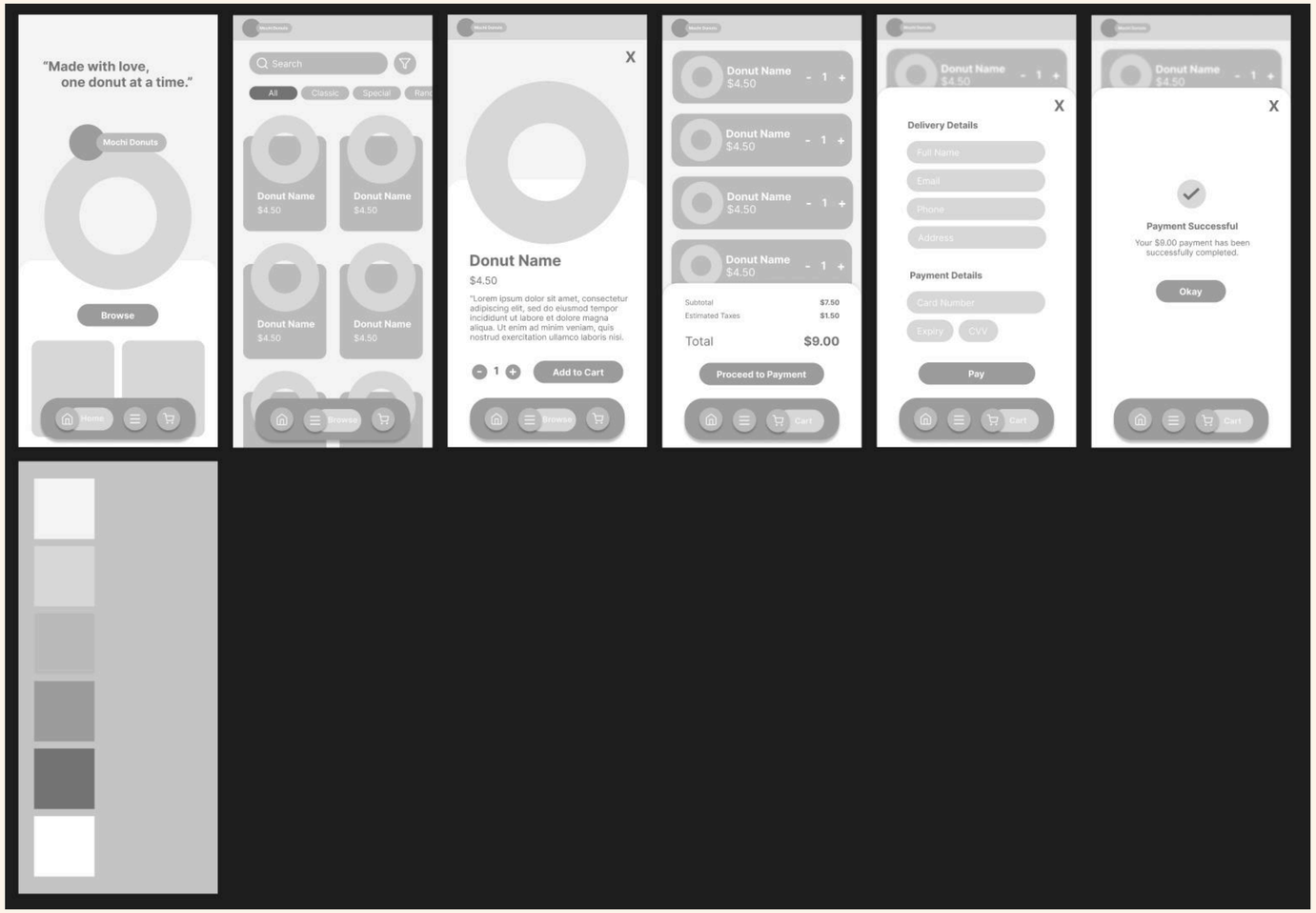


Throughout these sketches, I didn't worry too much alignment, but rather, tried quick sketches with varying navigation bars, hero pages and hero imagery, as well as the product grids.

For my final wireframe, I chose majority of the features from the 4th sketch, but also took features from other sketches, such as the navigation from the 3rd sketch.

Sketch Gallery

Wireframe Flow



The flow is very simple and easy to navigate because of the locked navigation bar. Flowing through the website becomes very easy as the navigation bar is always easily accessible to the user.

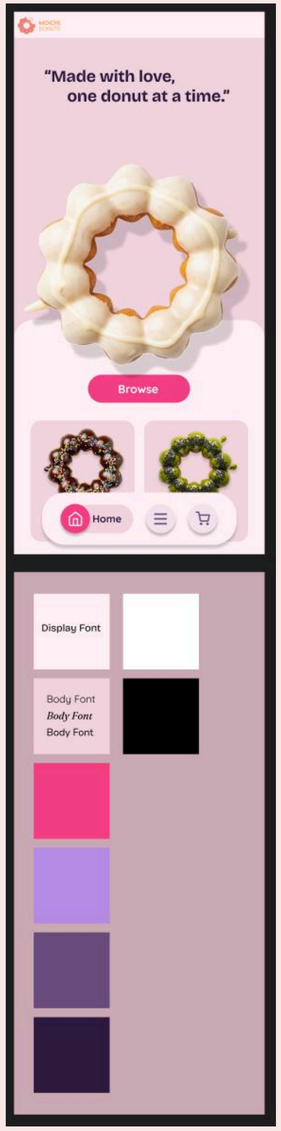
In my wireframe, I was influenced the most by my 4th and final sketch, however, I combined many differnent features from other sketches as well.

The flow is delibrately minimal, where each screen isn't loaded with information, and consists of a lot of whitespace. This was directly due to the original Mochi Donuts website feeling too empty, but also crowded in places. This redesign keeps a lot of the whitespace, but is evenly dense in places such as the product detail page, and cart, where this information helps the usability, while also not taking away from the visual aesthetic.



I did really appreciate the first experiment, however, the first impressions feel much more premium and professional, but not as playful as I intended. After getting feedback, many people also said that it felt like a dark-mode option, rather than the main colour palette.

It's also pulling away too far from the original Mochi Donuts brand, so returning users would feel like they're on a completely different website.

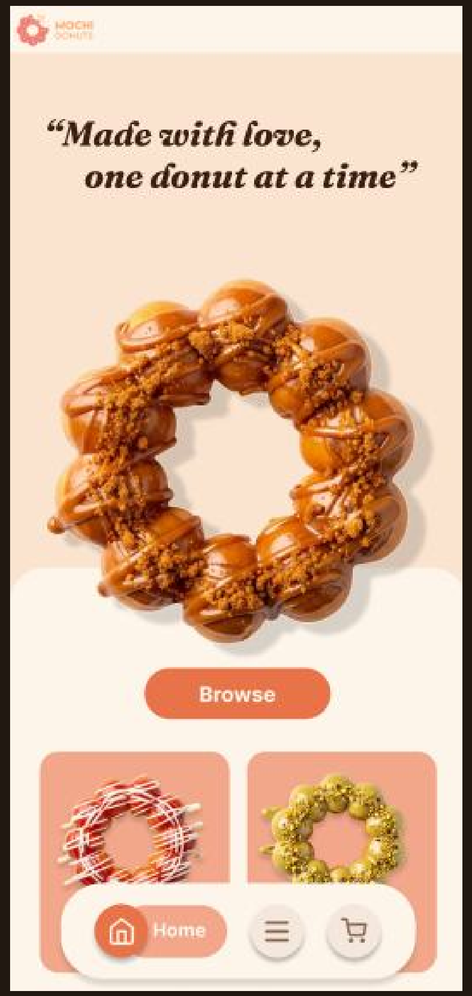


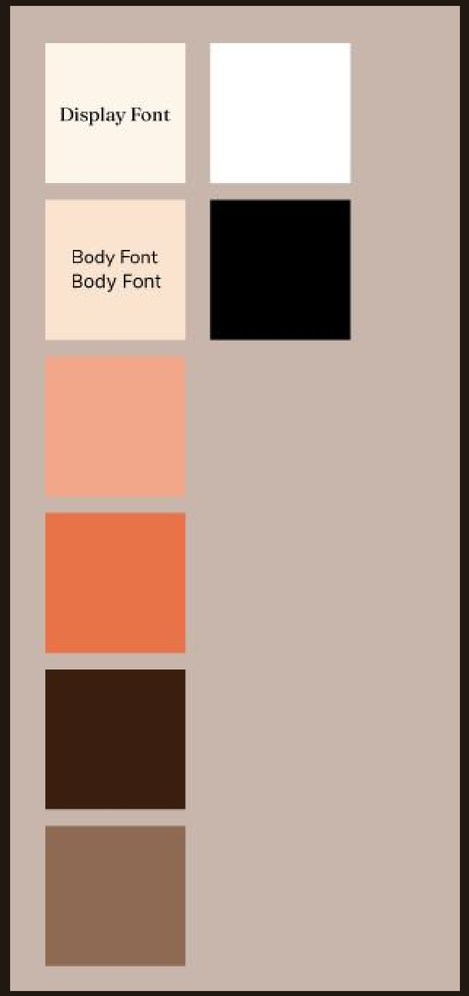
I believe this nailed the 'Sanrio-like' personality I wanted to express, but it felt too visually loud. It feels too playful and for children, rather than accommodating to a larger audience. I believe it would work very well if Mochi Donuts was targeted more at younger kids, but it feels like a weaker option for my target demographic.

This also doesn't feel like a colour palette and design which people would share on Instagram, or other social media; something which is crucial and I previously already discussed in my project goals.

I experimented with three visual directions for the mobile home-page design. My primary comparison was about colour scheme. Not because typography and spacing weren't important, but rather because I wanted my redesign to feel like a refinement of the existing brand, rather than a complete takeover. Palette was the one thing which provided me the most struggles, as I had many different approaches I wanted to take; much more compared to the layout and typography.

Art Directions





This final direction I explored felt like it extended the original brand's warm-peach identity. User's returning to the redesigned website should feel like it's the some brand, but better; this continuity is deliberate and directly the reason behind my choice.

I also really appreciate this pastel colour palette, which provides a lot of contrast for the figure-ground product imagery, making the website pop out vibrantly.

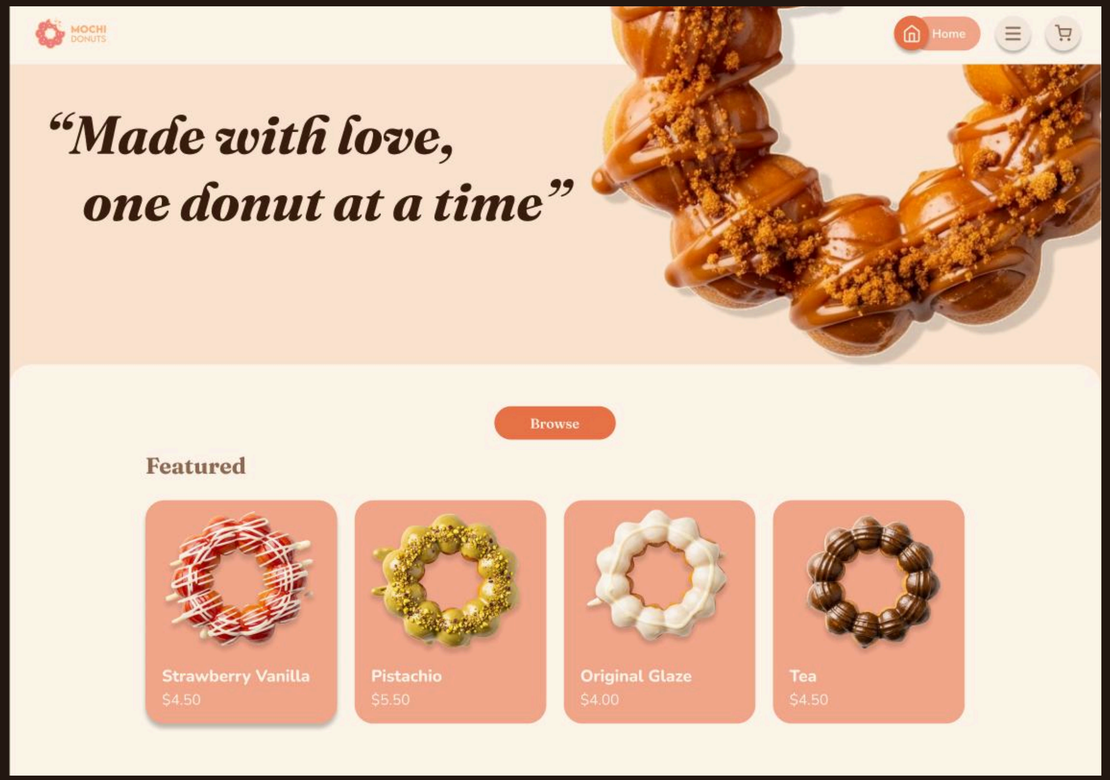
I think the typography choices of Fraunces for the display font, and a mix of Nunito, and Inter for the body fonts go well with the overall design of the website.

Art Directions

Homepage

Imagery Figure Ground

Good use of the imagery figure ground to integrate the donut images into the website,

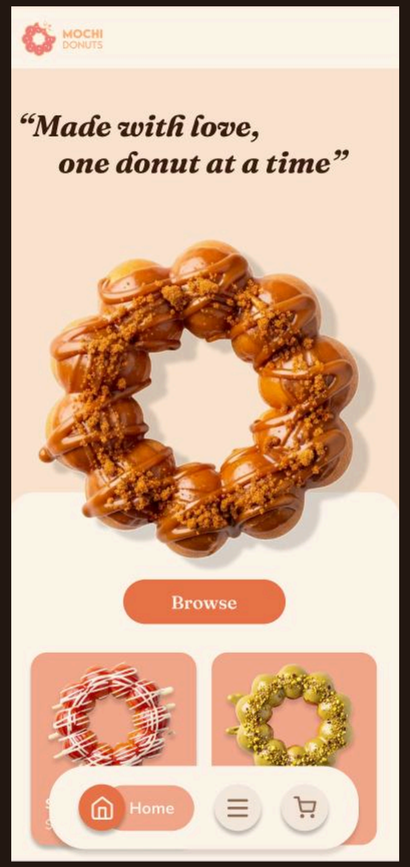


Lacking Content

The desktop version feels a bit lacking in overall content; lacking any scrolling features, or footer.

Hero Section

Large product imagery immediately communicates what the site is about. Users can understand the purpose within a few seconds without needing to read much text.



Navigation Bar

Overlay navigation bar makes it very easy to navigate through the website, and the unique layout adds to the personality.

Personality

Soft pastel colours and a clean / minimal layout creates a playful but still professional and polished feel, which fits the target audience.

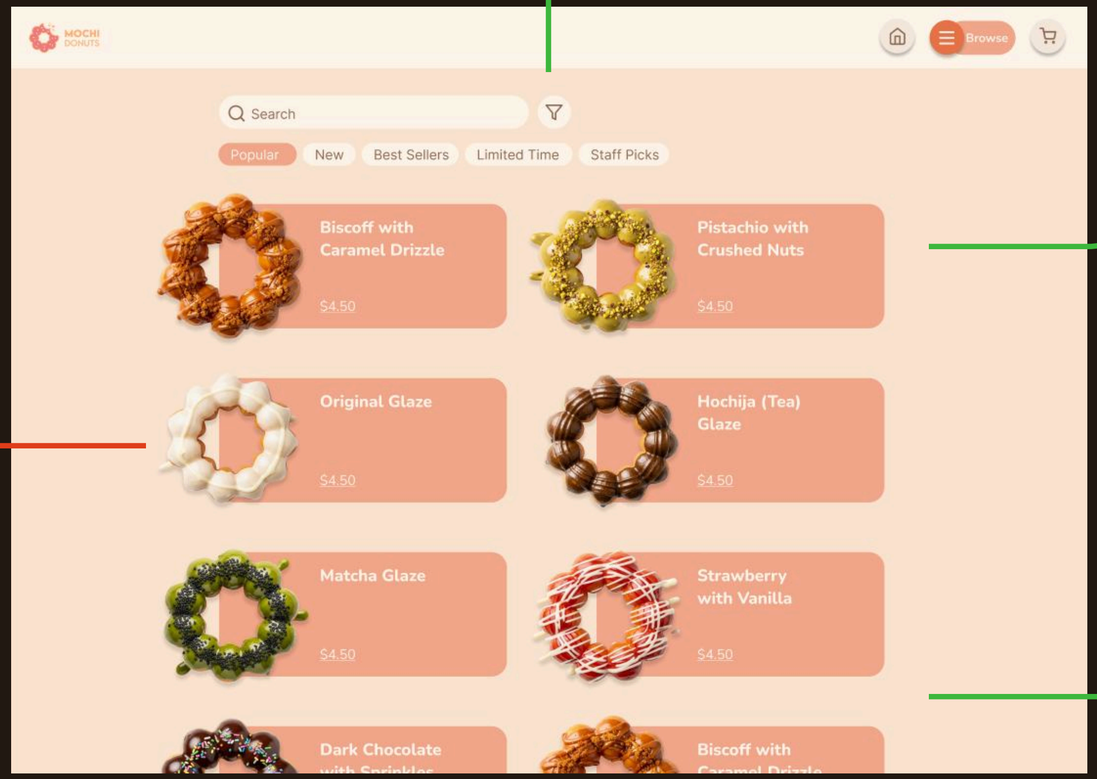
Product List

Search Bar and Filters

Clear and accessible search bar and filters; seperate category filters, and browsing filters.

Product List Spacing

Inconsistent spacing and margin between the title and pricing throughout the product cards.

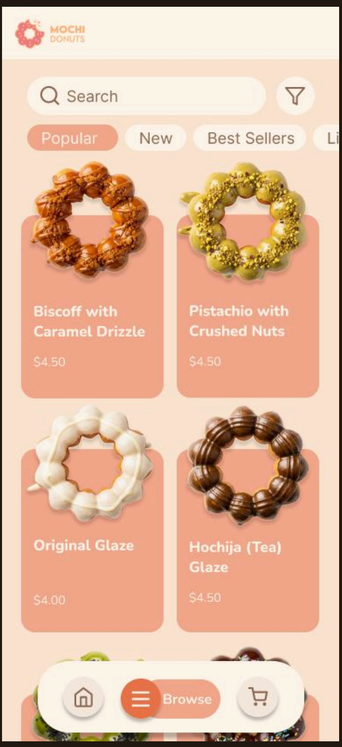


Grouping and Continuity

Consistent product cards with image, title and price, making the browsing flow simple and reducing cognitive load.

Product List

Product list is directly accessible throught buttons or the navigation bar, removing the hidden “View Menu” issue, or friction in finding the product list. Greatily improving the visiblity of system status.



Responsiveness

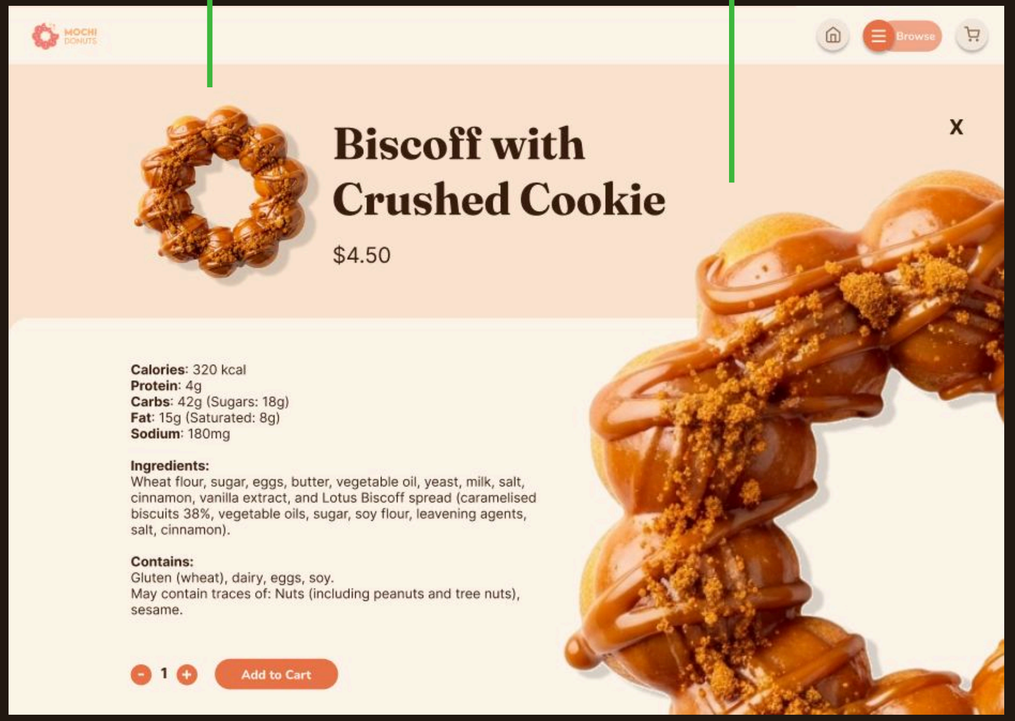
The layout transitions cleanly from desktop to mobile with minimal compromises, keeping the visual hierarchy and making the site feel equally satisfying across devices.

Visual Hierarchy

The product image, title, details, and purchase action follow a clear top to bottom visual hierarchy, making it very easy for the user to scan.

Figure Ground

The use of figure ground through the hero donut imagery makes the product details page pop out, and look attractive to the user. Making the website feel more alive, as well as visually pleasing.







Information Layout

On the mobile design, there is still extra information avaliable, however, no indication that you can scroll and see more nutritional information, decreasing usability and discoverability.

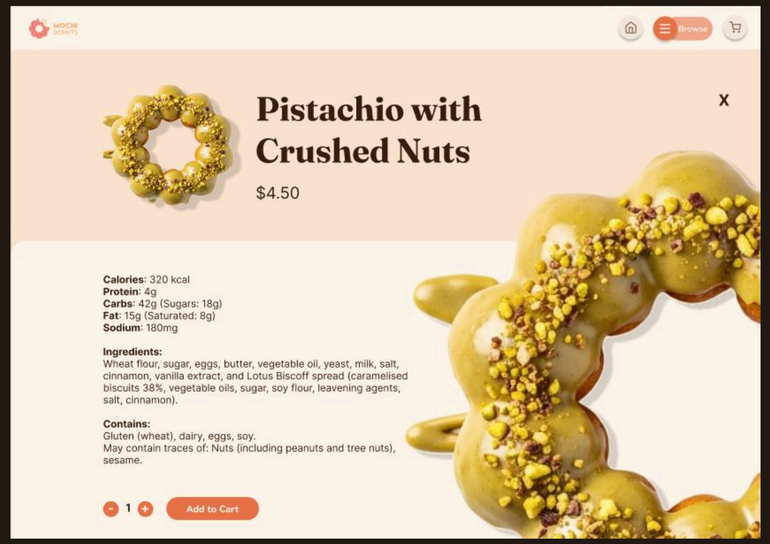
Responsiveness

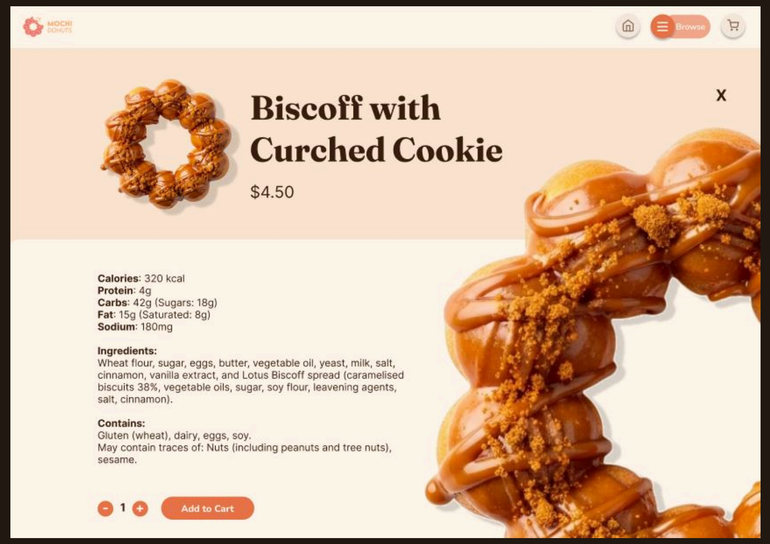
The layout shifts from desktop to mobile without losing hierarchy, preserving usability and interaction flow across devices.

Recognition over Recall

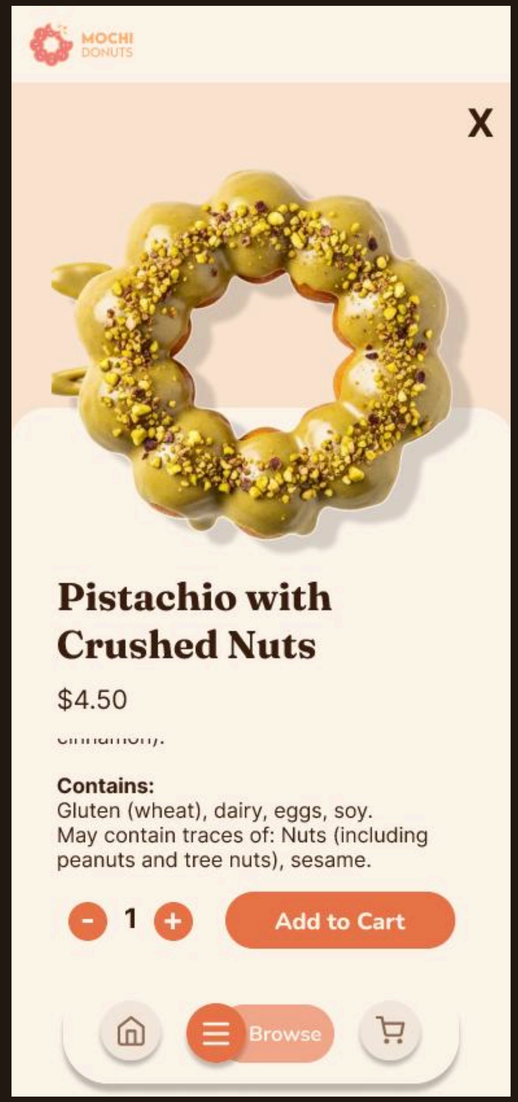
Both designs have nutritional information avaliable on the page itself, so the users don't have to look for the information, supporting recognition over recall.

Product Detail

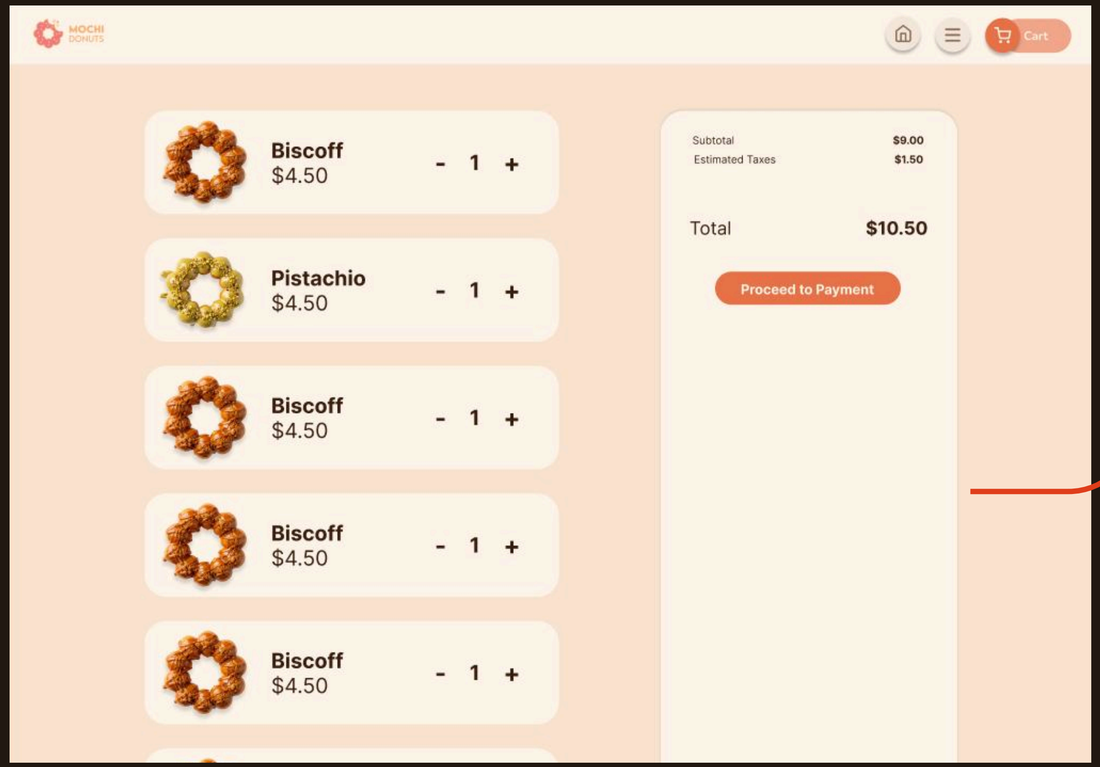








Product Detail



Excessive Whitespace

The order summary card has a lot of whitespace, making the right side feel a bit under-weighted compared to the cards on the left side.

Responsiveness

The mobile shopping cart cards are almost identical to the desktop cards, showing the responsiveness and consistency throughout devices.



Colour Consistency

The few choice of pastel colours, oranges, and brown typography are consistent throughout the website, maintaining visual consistency and strengthening brand cohesion across pages.

Common Checkout Layout

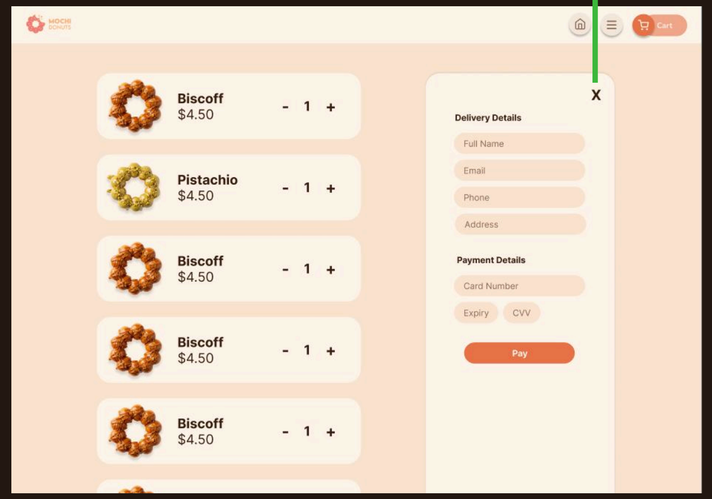
The checkout layout shows items on the left and then the order summary on the right. Standard layout is clear and familiar which reduces friction.

Shopping Cart

Checkout

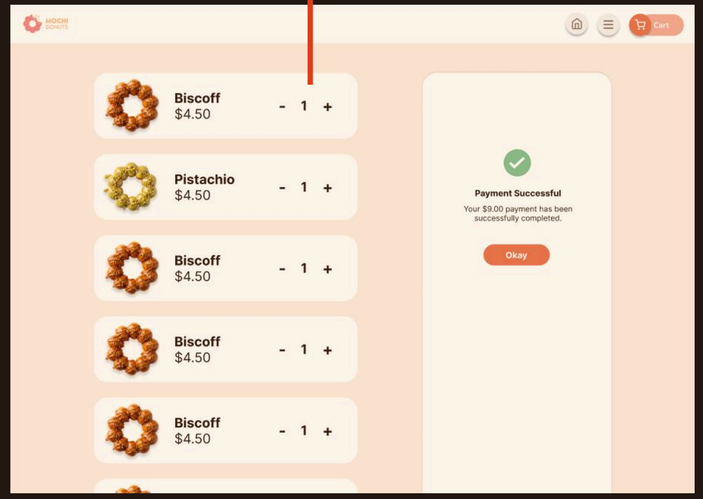
Reversible Flow

User is able to go back to the cart, or an earlier step, supporting user control and freedom.



Product Quantity

The quantity editor still shows despite being done with the order, making it easy for the user to get confused on why.

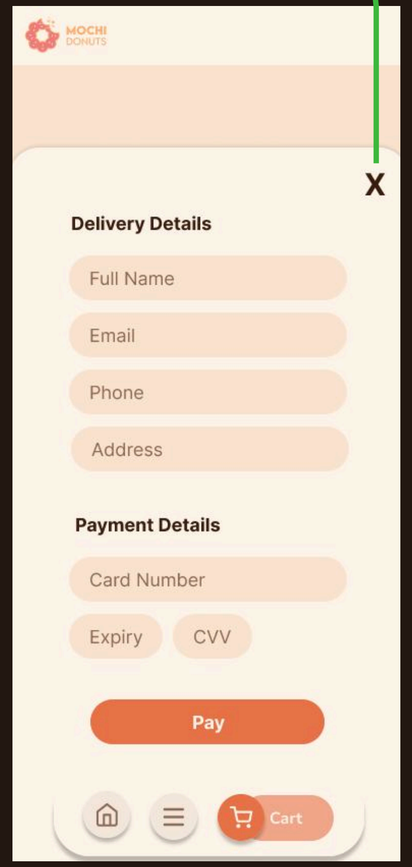


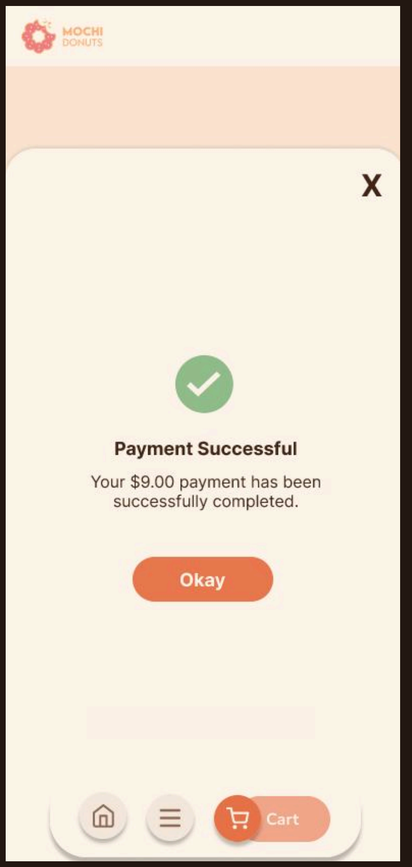
State Consistency

On desktop, the left cart summary stays visually identical from the cart, throughout the checkout, and the users stay in the same card they starting with.

Confirmation

The confirmation reuses the same layout with a clear successful notification at the end of the order. Stays consistency as well as keeping the brand image intact.





Consistent Imagery
Every donut imagery is from the same angle and is consistent. The subtle dropshadow use also creates a strong figure-ground seperation that makes the product pop off the page.

Consistency
Consistent product cards, spacing, and alignment throughout the website. The colour scheme is strict, and the same palette is used throughout the entire website, as well as the typography. Also has a lot of unique brand personality.

First Impression
The large product imagery alongside the quote, right at the start, communicates the websites purpose in under 5 seconds.

Navigation and Flow
The navigation bar which sits in the same position throughout the mobile, or desktop designs, make the navigation and flow much simpler and easier. It also helps with the usability throughout the website, and greatly decreases cognitive load.

Nutritional Information
The easy access to nutritional information on the product details page, rather than being hidden behind any tabs or buttons like other e-commerce websites, help with the website's recognition over recall.

Responsiveness
Layouts transition smoothly between desktop and mobile with minimal structural changes, maintaining the visual hierarchy and usability across devices

Nutritional Information Affordance (Mobile)
On the mobile Product Detail page, there is no visual cue that the nutritional information can be vertically scroll, and reveals more information. Even a subtle hint would improve this (I was unable to implement it myself within figma).

Excessive White Space
Despite the minimalist, and less content being a design choice, throughout the website, especially the desktop version, places feel like there is too much white space. In cases the white space also feels like the website is missing content, in making it feel a bit hollow.

Mobile Top Navigation
On mobile, the top of each screen feels a bit bare, as all it consists of is a small logo, and empty peach rectangle. This is where users typically expect a navigation bar, or search, or any other action. Because of the unconventional bottom navigation, it leaves the top feeling a bit empty.

Critical Analysis

Navigation Flow	Overall Feedback
1. Home Page 2. Go to Product Details (Used both browse and also the navigation bar) 3. Reading the Product Detail Page. 4. Adding the Pistachio and Biscoff Donuts to cart. 5. Go to cart, and finish the cart process.	Overall feedback was almost entirely positive, despite me telling the user to be a bit harsher than usual. She understood the site within seconds, and could navigate the pages quite easily. She said the visuals felt “clean” and “like something she’d actually shop on.” There wasn’t any confusion on navigation, no contrast complaints, and she didn’t experience any moments where she was confused about where to click next, like she experienced during the original Mochi Donuts website walkthrough. The one issue which she came across was not realising the nutritional block on the mobile Product Detail page scrolled. She appreciated me including calories and other information, but didn’t notice the ingredients or allergens. This directly confirms the affordance issue I already mentioned earlier, where many users won’t even notice this on the mobile design. A minor comment she made was that the desktop homepage felt “a tiny bit empty.” Nothing serious, but just a slight remark, which I also felt was the case after finishing the design. She really liked the constant use of large imagery, and the overlay / drop shadow on the images, she did comment on these a few times. Saying it adds very nicely to the aesthetic.

User Feedback